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r/india • 14y ago

u/golisoda



I work at the Centre for Internet and Society, India. AMA

My name is Sunil Abraham. I do policy research at the Centre for Internet and Society, India [<http://www.cis-india.org>]. Happy to answer questions regarding my work at the Centre. We have research programmes in areas such as accessibility, access to knowledge, openness, internet governance, telecom etc.

https://twitter.com/sunil_abraham/status/286339350457876480

↑ 100 ↓ · 88



naveen_reloaded • 14y ago

First of all , thanks for taking time and doing this ama for [r/india](#) .

Here are my questions categorized :

1.) UID / Aadhaar :

- What is your thought on aadhaar ? Does it really help the poor as stated my nilekani or another hideous tool for mass profiling , surveillance by govt ?
- There is always a confusion about UID and SSN (US) , can you clear that for us ?
- Given the recent database hacking and stuffs like that , is UID safe ? If at all database is compromised , what will be the effect on people ? coz unlike online password , once compromised biometric of a person is compromised forever.
- Last have you enrolled in UID ? if not , any plans in doing it ? :D

2.) Internet

- BB speed is almost the same for some years now. Last time i spoke with one of the ISP CEO , he said ,its about NIXI(<http://www.nixi.in/>), charging hefty amount for internal routing(peering) , what is your and CIS take on this ?
- Has CIS done any research on this subject ?
- For some years now , only ISP in my place (town panchayat) is BSNL ,why govt is not pursuing prvt players to expand into villages ? Why stick to cities alone ?

3.) CIS :

- Can you elaborate on things and programs you do in CIS and how we can as community contribute to it ? (remember once i saw your stream) And how often meetings / lectures are streamed ?
- Do you think CIS can become the EFF for India ? We all wish it should...

4.) Law:

- When can we expect "Privacy Law" to come into force , we know Pranesh was part of it .
- How much do we know what kind of tools are been used by our govt to spy on its people ?
- Your thoughts on John doe order..

28

**golisoda OP** • 14y ago

Thanks so much for suggesting that I do this AMA. And thanks for the patience with my newbie questions when trying to initiate this.

1.) UID/Aadhaar

- A summary of my views on UID can be found in this article. <http://www.business-standard.com/india/news/do-we-needaadhar-scheme/463324/>
- SSN unlike the UID central repository is not a centralized store of authentication factors and therefore does not pose a significant risk
- The UIDAI assures us that the data will be safe but we don't know for sure. This is basically security by obscurity. If we had a decentralized architecture we would have to worry about the database getting compromised.
- I am planning to register and then to release my biometrics and my UID onto the Internet to the general public as an electronic art installation titled "plausible deniability"

2.) Internet

- I have not heard about this. I will ask around and get back.
- No. We have no research on interconnection [peering and transit] in India. This is a very important but difficult area to study because transit is dominated by private arrangements.

3.) CIS

- We basically conduct policy and academic research. We are always looking to partner with experts, you can learn more about our research programmes/projects since we post regular updates on our blog. All you need to do is mail us indicating which programme/project you would like to volunteer for.
- I hope that one day we will become the EFF of India. They are definitely amongst our heroes!

4.) Law

- No idea. I have heard unconfirmed rumours at the Department of Personnel and Training is working on a new draft of the bill based on Justice AP Shah Committee report.
- Some RTI responses from BSNL and MTNL indicate that state run ISP are not doing comprehensive data retention or deep-packet inspection. Though these practices may be more common amongst private ISP.
- John Doe orders violate the principles of natural justice and therefore are completely unjustified in most cases.



10

naveen_reloaded • 14y ago

We are thrilled to have you here in [r/india](#). I have been following you, CIS, pranesh for sometime now, so thought your participation here would help greatly.

1.) UID

- Thanks, but my contention is once it's compromised and reversed (if that's possible), will



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security /encryption/database security around UID, so we dont know much about it. If possible can CIS or you can do a article on it ?

- LOL , excellent idea ..

2.) Internet

- Thanks , Also can you tell us more on why airtel being the fat owner of the indian pipes(internet) , can sell its bandwidth for cheaper price for prvt players , when they themselves have costly , FUP`d up plans ? Also why should our internet pipes be owned by airtel / tata , when it could be public-prvt ownership or by Non-profit organization ?
- Sorry for not asking first , your thought on FUP - Fair Usage Policy .

3.) CIS

- We love to participate in such projects , also can you make such programs / lectures / etc available on stream or youtube on regular basis ?
- Now that you have created a reddit account , would you post such updates here and upcoming programs etc ? :)
- You said in other comment , EFF has good funding , is CIS planning to raise some funds ? And we would love to see CIS take some issues to court , just like EFF. How often EFF contacts CIS ? And can you tell us more on both these organization relationship , if any ?



3

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Thanks for your kind words.

1.) UID

- Ideally the UID project should use digital signatures and smart cards as authentication technology. Biometric ideally should also be used for high-value transactions only like land registration. I will write a more detailed article on UID security in the near future.
- :-)

2.) Internet

- Not sure if there is any law prohibiting Airtel from doing what you claim it does. Consortia based back-haul management is something that Shyam Ponappa at CIS has been advocating. Please his article here: <http://business.rediff.com/column/2010/jul/01/guest-how-india-can-catch-up-on-broadband.htm>
- FUP are legit as per our regulator and increasingly the trend across the globe. The days of unlimited internet are unfortunately over. We however need more crowd sourced research to understand both the privacy implication and fraudulent billing as a result of FUP.

3.) CIS

- We will most definitely try and stream as many talks and events as possible. We are using justin.tv/cisindia at the moment. We post video links to our event pages once they are uploaded. But we looking for more FOSS and open standards friendly



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standards and etiquette on reddit more fully.

- We are preparing technical and administrative infrastructure for public fund raising - we hope to launch within the next 3 months. We are in regular touch EFF especially for privacy research. See: <https://www.eff.org/deeplinks/2012/12/biometric-id-systems-grew-internationally-2012-and-so-did-concerns-about-privacy> & <https://www.eff.org/deeplinks/2012/05/growing-mistrust-india-biometric-id-scheme> & <https://www.eff.org/deeplinks/2012/09/indias-gargantuan-biometric-database-raises-big-questions> We have also attended their recent Camp on surveillance http://wiki.surveillancehumanrights.org/Rights_Camp_Brazil

3

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[deleted] • 14y ago

Not an expert, but doesn't a centralised database more of security risk than a de-centralised one?

1

⊖ thetuxracer • 14y ago

like dam icky ink squalid aware frighten literate label combative

This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](#)

6



golisoda OP • 14y ago



We are open to having anyone with a keen interest in Internet policy and research. We have no firm requirements when it comes to educational qualifications or prior experience. My username is inspired by my love for appropriate, local, renewable technologies. Thanks so much for having me on reddit.

1

thetuxracer • 14y ago

How do you go about performing research on policies? Do you just put forward a contradicting and better policy when government policies err? Or do you have a roadmap in place, and you actively try to steer government/bureaucratic opinions in the public interest?

1



KrapBag • 14y ago

Honest question. Do we genuinely have any control over the internet?

No matter how much we fight on about free speech, I'm pretty sure if the government wants, it could pull the plug on the internet on a whim. (hypothetically asking, since if they do such a thing now, there would be considerable backlash all over the world)

⊖ Or is it far more convoluted than that?

Also, how can we make people in India more internet-literate? In the sense, how to make them better social beings even in the cyberspace?

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control users on the Internet. It is a constant battle between citizens and governments/big business. Sometimes we win and on most occasions they win. Over the last 15 years governments and big business have almost succeeded in extinguishing online anonymity. They have not been as successful in tackling IPR infringement though.

Even if the Government has a legal or technical kill switch they would use it only as last resort because of the tremendous political implications.

You cannot use the law to enforce polite behaviour online. Polite behaviour can only be encouraged through self-regulation, community regulation and good examples.

2

**abhishekraiiji** • 14y ago

What do you think about Internet penetration in India? Will mobile technology (3G + cheap smartphones and tablets) help spread the internet faster and cover up for the past? Can you share some data for the same?

7

**golisoda OP** • 14y ago

Internet penetration in India is still pathetic. Cheap devices are definitely going to help. Here is some coverage of a recent presentation of CIS research work on your second question. <http://www.patentprogress.org/2012/12/19/patent-less-smartphone-innovation-and-global-technology-markets/> I will also try and upload the presentation file soon. In order to protect these innovations at the bottom of the pyramid we may need to consider IP-related policy reform.



5

**neoronin** • 14y ago

Can you elaborate on what IP-related policy reforms are being considered?

0

**golisoda OP** • 14y ago

The policy reforms currently being considered by the government are VAS regulation. Royalty caps by the Reserve Bank of India have been lifted. Maybe they can be reintroduced in a more targeted fashion. We are suggesting patent pools with compulsory licenses. This option has still not been considered in India. Here is the presentation. <http://www.slideshare.net/golisoda/pervasive-technologies>



1

**etrast75** • 14y ago

What is the mandate of CIS India? Is it supported by the government or is it a private trust?

4

**golisoda OP** • 14y ago

We aim to protect citizen and consumer interest on the Internet in particular and information societies more generally through policy and academic research. We are a registered non-profit mostly supported by donor agencies. We have gotten some support from individuals and the Indian government. Please see: <http://cis-india.org/internet-governance/sources-cis-funding>

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How do you view India's (Kapil Sibal's) proposal to regulate the Internet? Do you believe that a credible balance is possible between free speech and the greater welfare of the society (I am referring the North East migrant exodus issue).

4

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Governments cannot regulate the Internet. Government can regulate users, corporations and on occasion the technological standards. Mostly deregulation is the way to go. But on occasion regulation like data protection or privacy law is important to protect consumer rights and the public internet. Regulation of speech of ordinary citizens should be kept to the absolute minimum only when there is clear and direct harm otherwise it will have unintended consequences. Please see my Tehelka article and ET article on how to regulate speech online: Online censorship: How government should approach regulation of speech http://articles.economictimes.indiatimes.com/2012-12-02/news/35530550_1_internet-censorship-speech-unintended-consequences & Censoring the Internet: A brief manual <http://cis-india.org/internet-governance/www-tehelka-com-sunil-abraham-august-23-2012-censoring-the-internet> [Original link on Tehelka seems to be missing]

6

**iznograte** • 14y ago

Could you share your opinions on Internet Censorship with respect to the recent website (vimeo, xmarks, torrents) blocks? I mean, the power of the internet comes from the information exchange and the near unlimited access to data. As a policy researcher what kinds of data/information exchange do you see as being in the white, grey and black areas?

4

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Black areas for me are things like child pornography, animal pornography, voyeurism, privacy intrusions, evidence of crimes without the consent of the victim etc. Everything else should be ideally be white. Grey is when you need a judge to determine the potential for harm such as hate speech, disruption to public order and safety. Please see my ET and Tehelka articles to understand my approach to speech regulation.

5

**Reddicator** • 14y ago

Hi Sunil! First off, thanks for the work you do! Your efforts are part of what keeps democracy in India ticking and vibrant. I have a few questions, I hope you'll have time to respond to all of them!

1. I remember a few comments in India which compared the CIS to the EFF in the US. Do you think such a comparison is accurate?
2. You are one of the few knowledgeable voices today who tries to actively engage with lawmakers on, well, the internet and society. How do you find the response from politicians to the issues you raise? How does the bureaucracy respond?
3. I was encouraged when P. Rajeev raised the issue of the IT rules in the Rajya Sabha, but rather disappointed when the debate was rather short, and ended with merely a verbal promise from Kapil Sibal to reconsider. Has there been any progress or real reconsideration of the rules?
4. Going forward, do you see the efforts of motivated organizations and individuals like you as being

4

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

1. EFF has been very successful in raising funds from the public therefore they are much more financially resilient than us. They also have quite a large team of experienced lawyers. They are able to approach courts unlike us. We stop at policy research so we are in other words only a pale shadow of EFF.
2. It is not easy to reach politicians in power. I guess they have busy lives. Politicians who are not in power are easier to reach. Large majority in the bureaucracy are honest and hardworking and easy to work with when there is common cause. For example - IPR reform at the WIPO, privacy law etc.
3. As far as I know nothing has happened publicly since the debate. Maybe there is some internal progress at the Ministry.
4. We have no idea whether we will succeed. There seem to be global trends in terms of regulation and deregulation. Telecom deregulation is in but so is surveillance. We can only keep hoping for the best here in India. Sometimes India cherry picks from international best/worst practices and on other occasions India chooses a unique and appropriate path. Hopefully a more active citizenry will improve the quality of Internet-related policy and implementation here.

4

i2rohan • 14y ago

Hello. Thank you for taking out time for this and a very happy new year to you! My questions are:

1. What are the chances that the IT Act, 66A can be amended to provide full freedom to people to express themselves online, like say, in the USA? Because the freedom of speech act 19 (A), also comes with certain clauses, which the Govt. thinks is 'reasonable'. Unlike in the case of US, where the laws of freedom of speech do not come with any caveats attached.
- ⊖ 2. Any idea about the efforts the Govt is making to understand how the internet works? From what I've read online the 66A was reported to be a cut-copy-paste of British laws done in a shoddy manner. Is CIS making any efforts to educate the Govt. on this subject?
3. Is the Music/Movies industry lobby in India powerful enough to force the Govt. into seriously considering something along the lines of ACTA or SOPA here in India?

Also just a note of thanks to all you good folks at CIS. Thank you for the efforts you guys put in.

4

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Thanks for the seasons greetings. Wishing you and your loved ones the very best for 2013.

1. People in the USA don't have the full freedom to express themselves online. They are subjected to less and perhaps more enlightened regulation. My colleague Pranesh Prakash says "Freedom of speech is enshrined in the Constitution of India, which came into force in 1950, and specifically in Article 19(1)(a), which guarantees that 'all citizens shall have the right to freedom of speech and expression'. While in the United States, it wasn't until the 1920s that the Supreme Court struck down a law or governmental action on freedom of speech grounds, in India, just one year after the constitution was adopted, government actions against both left- and right-wing political speech were struck down for violating Article



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expression. These included speech pertaining to 'friendly relations with foreign states', 'public order' and 'incitement to an offence'. In 1963, in response to the 1962 war with China, the 'sovereignty and integrity of India' was also added, taking the number of categories of permissible restrictions up to eight. While the constitution categorically stipulates that no further restrictions should be imposed, courts have on occasion added to the list (privacy, for instance) through judicial interpretation without explicitly stating that they are doing so. Comparisons are often drawn between the constitution's 'reasonable restrictions' and the categorical prohibition enshrined in the US Constitution's First Amendment: 'Congress shall make no law ... abridging the freedom of speech, or of the press' – a meaningless comparison as there are indeed many categories of speech that are not seen as being protected under the US constitution and even speech that is protected may be restrained in a number of ways."



2. Understanding how technology works is essential to understanding how to regulate use in an enlightened fashion. I hope more techie consider becoming politicians and bureaucrats.
3. I don't think the rights-holder lobby in India is as powerful as that in the US. Also Indian policy-makers have traditionally had better understanding of access to medicine and access to knowledge.

7

i2rohan • 14y ago

Thank you very much for a detailed response.

2

jackerhack • 14y ago

It's not very useful to compare the Freedom of Speech clauses in the Indian and US constitutions. They come from different cultures and have completely different histories of interpretation and enforcement.

The text of the constitution is only a reference clause, with many layers of culture and legality on top that change how they play out in reality. To make meaningful change requires understanding the full stack, not just the base layer.

1



sig-seg-me • 14y ago

I apologize in advance for the open-endedness of these questions :)

- The UN and other organizations that look at human development factors talk about internet access being one of the major indicators towards a better standard of living. Given this, how do you think internet access will help Indians (in both rural and urban settings) improve their standard of living? I'm not talking about changes that may manifest with 10-20 years of access. I would like to know what immediate impact you/CIS think that internet access will have to someone who does not have it today.
- I see a severe problem with India-centric content being available on the internet. As always, most content on the internet remains US dominated. Countries in Europe and Eastern Asia seem to be far far better at generating content too, albeit in their own languages. Why do you think there is so little India-centric content on the internet? What can be done to fix this?
- Related to the question above: Most Government websites are, to put it bluntly, absolute trash. They seem to have the information I want, but finding it is a painful exercise in navigating through



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- Educational institutions around India seem to be as bad, if not worse, than the govt organizations at maintaining useful websites. The benefits to them are immense and immediate. Why do you think this is? Why do they not take the internet 'seriously'?

2

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Those are not open ended questions. Those are complicated and difficult questions.

1. Very broadly one could say that someone with affordable access to networked technologies will have more opportunities to learn and a larger social network that may result in safety and livelihood benefits. But many studies have indicated that unless there is a comprehensive enabling environment there is only a novelty effect. Farmer's get better price for their agro-output put only for a short period till someone learns how to game the system. Students with ICTs do better academically but only for a limited time after which motivation will suffer.
2. The elites that currently have access to the Internet are comfortable with English and therefore not keen on Indic content. Once Internet penetration increases dramatically we will see upsurge in Indic content production and consumption. Most of the enabling infrastructure such as availability of fonts, input methods, proper rendering, spell check s/w, grammar check s/w, machine translation s/w etc. is still urgently required. Also there is limited openly licenses voice-to-text and text-to-voice engines for Indic languages. We need systemic high-quality publicly funded research to address the lack of enabling infrastructure.
3. The GoI has published Guidelines for Indian Government Websites - <http://web.guidelines.gov.in>. Unfortunately, there is not sufficient detail in these guidelines and very few websites actually comply with these guidelines. One of the systemic issues with the execution is that NIC has a near monopoly on most government website projects. That has to be fixed through procurement policy reform. Then we need open resources such as HTML, CSS templates etc. that can be shared across websites and sustained capacity building programmes for government web masters. Finally, it is a question of hardcore business process re-engineering - otherwise as you rightly point out an inefficient offline process is just ported online with all its glaring inadequacies.
4. I have no idea why educational institutions have terrible websites. Is it because we are focusing on training computer operators vs. computer scientists. By not exposing Indian students to Free/Open Source Software - maybe we are reducing them to point-and-click engineers which no real understanding of the internal details. Is it because these institutions are big and old and therefore have reduced institutional agility and space for innovation? I am only guessing. It is indeed tragic.

3

naveen_reloaded • 14y ago

slightly off-topic , but related to govt websites.

Recently there was an article or discussion here (dont remember which one) , about how UID servers going to handle such a large number of request , when it has to match with millions of data , each one around (5-7MB - from UID documents) is so big , already when we are seeing IRCTC buckling under pressure.

1

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

The comparison will be done against a biometric template not the image. It will be done



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deduplication however will get slower and slower as research from our distinguished fellow Hans Varghese Mathews demonstrates <http://cis-india.org/internet-governance/biometric-identification>

1

[Continue this thread](#)**sig-seg-me** • 14y ago

Thanks a bunch for the answers.

Although, to be perfectly honest, I have a lot more questions now :p. perhaps I'll save them for the next AMA :)

1

TheBigLebowski • 14y ago

I guess CIS was also involved with spreading awareness of textreaders like Tara for the visually challenged persons. can you share some updates on it?

2

**golisoda OP** • 14y ago

We have helped with the formulation of the National Electronic Accessibility Policy. Unfortunately, it has still not been notified by the government. We have published a report on the accessibility of government websites in India. <http://cis-india.org/accessibility/accessibility-of-government-websites-in-india>. CIS now has support from Hans Foundation to improve Indic language support on the free/open source software screen reader NVDA and text-to-speech engine eSpeak. That project is slowly starting and monthly updates will be available in the near future. [edited]

2

TheBigLebowski • 14y ago

Great ! Kudos to you and the entire team for all the hard work on enabling accessibility features for persons with disabilities.

2

[deleted] • 14y ago

i think this job has good pay! How do i get job in CIS?

2

**golisoda OP** • 14y ago

You need to send in an application <http://cis-india.org/jobs>

2

**maverick340** • 14y ago

- FUP Question

In this day and age of cloud computing and digital content delivery (Steam, Netflix, Saavn) what business does FUP have existing? I dont mind paying for content as long as its priced resonably, but how the heck am I supposed to access it if my Internet Provider is going to cripple me?

I hate FUP myself and would do anything to get rid of them. But subsidies across markets are highly avoidable. We can't ask tourist destinations to pay transportation providers for the traffic they generate. Unless we can demonstrate large scale public harm caused by FUP it is unlikely that the telecom regulator will act against the practice. If you are worried about network neutrality and freedom of expression implications of FUPs - ideally you should approach a court or the competition regulator. I am not sure India needs an explicit network neutrality law at this point. Again this needs proper technical research to demonstrate that your ISP is crippling you.

2

pornjesus • 14y ago

Again this needs proper technical research to demonstrate that your ISP is crippling you.

⊖ Does it? All it needs is an assortment of "plan" pamphlets from the major ISP carries to show how stupid FUP policies are. The amount of free data per month alone is completely messed up. There are plans that allow upto 5GB free data a month on a 2 Mbps line, after which speeds go down, or "data packs" can be bought. That's crappy, we don't really need to explain to you how crappy it is, do we? Even 40GB/month like at least one major ISP provides before capping bandwidth etc is stupid to anyone who's spent a month on reddit and sees people streaming all kinds of things from Netflix etc, and sees a youtube link on almost every fifth click. The rest of the world is eating terabytes every month; India's counting their usage in megabytes, like it's petrol, man.

The facts are right there for the taking, and I refuse to believe that demonstration is what's not happening. Bureaucracy and the same old corruption monster at every level of almost every organization is what's keeping these ridiculous laws up.

2

naveen_reloaded • 14y ago

Not to forget this negative feedback

FUP > Less Consumption by mass > Proof that more people use less > Decrease FUP even more > Cycle continues..

Yes i agree , that these FUP stifle on what we can do , for eg , if i like to stream a game on twitch tv , i currently cant, given the crappy low speed bb , or even if i move to city and get better BB , i will still have to face the FUP wall. This is just one example. FUP is mainly put in place to protect their interest under the pretext that heavy user cause network congestion , or read it as "torrenting" . List of legitimate use with good BB plan would include

- 1.) Seeding Open source stuffs
- 2.) Streaming
- 3.) Massively use cloud storage on the go
- 4.) penetration of video calls and letting go of voice calls completely , just like we moved to whatsapp from usually messaging.
- 5.) Hosting our own small sites (static ip)
- 6.) Even become relay for TOR network



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**maribha** • 14y ago

Hi Sunil, Can you provide insights and related data on consumption of content in English vs regional languages?

3

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Unfortunately, we have no data on that. With some effort perhaps we could say something using open data from sites like Wikipedia. Maybe Digital Empowerment Foundation knows more about this.

2

maribha • 14y ago

Thank you Sunil.

Yes, I did talk to someone who worked with DEF. His insight was quite surprising. He said that people even in remote towns and villages want to learn and access content in English. It has important implications for people who want to create content for mobile platforms targeted at people in these markets, especially when they have something like an Aakash in their hands. Content is going to be key to increasing adoption rates.

Ofcourse, integrating dynamic translation services like Google Translate can provide more options to people.

So it would be great to collate and analyse data in this respect.

1

**nileshtrivedi** • 14y ago

(1) What is the current status of laws on hosting free and open Wi-Fi networks?

(2) What is the legal status of VoIP and how does the future look like? Do you foresee IP-to-PSTN calls being allowed anytime soon?

(3) What is the best way techies with no money but skills and time can help CIS?

3

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

1. According to my colleague Pranesh there is a DoT order to ISPs prohibiting them from letting their customers run open Wi-Fi networks. This is could most probably be challenged as unconstitutional.
2. VOIP [IP-to-IP] is legal as far as I can tell. No, I don't see IP-to-PSTN allowed anytime soon because incumbent telcos will resist that as long as they can.
3. Techie with skills should support our research activities by giving talks, training us, writing blog entries, sharing the research load etc.

4

**neoronin** MOD • 14y ago

Legit. Has provided verification via his twitter account. Also we have previously posted about this in an upcoming IAmA's thread.



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jackerhack • 14y ago

What exactly does CIS do?

2



golisoda OP • 14y ago

You mean apart from hosting hackers [<http://dorkbot.org/dorkbotbangalore/>] and social entrepreneurs [<http://hasgeek.com/>] that share some of our values? In short, it is mostly answer emails.

3



HITsWorthTurkingFor • 14y ago

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Centre_for_Internet_and_Society_%28India%29

2

highlighte • 14y ago

1

[deleted] • 14y ago

Comment deleted by user



golisoda OP • 14y ago

You are absolutely right. Having 5 trackers on our website is pure hypocrisy. I will discuss this with our webmasters at the earliest.

12

[deleted]

Comment has been removed



golisoda OP • 14y ago

Excellent suggestions. Thanks a ton!

6

achshar • 14y ago

Google analytics is a tool for collecting information. The info does not go to Google (not by default at least, but even when it does go to Google it is anonymised first), it only goes to website owners. There is nothing wrong with using Google analytics. You must trust the website owners, they can collect a ton of other info anyways without using google analytics. Same goes for Facebook connect, it only takes user info if user has approved the website (or set the appropriate settings on Facebook itself IIRC)

-1

[deleted] • 14y ago

Comment deleted by user



golisoda OP • 14y ago

Sorry which twitter handle? CIS does not have an official position on many such questions. We are



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neuronin • 14y ago

I think he is referring to the episode of 18-20 twitter handles which were banned by the Gol recently. This includes the redditindia twitter handle also.



2



golisoda OP • 14y ago

Completely unjustified and counter productive. No evidence in my opinion linking those twitter handles to the exodus.

4



[deleted] • 14y ago

Comment deleted by user

naveen_reloaded • 14y ago

Nice idea imo. CIS could do something like TEDx , call good speakers , or ask students themselves to present on a topic.. They are the ones who should be more aware of these trends (censorship , free speech , etc)

2



golisoda OP • 14y ago

We are a little scared of organising events. We have organised many many events in the past but it is always a challenge getting an audience for our events. Maybe they are too boring. Maybe if we have strong partners such as yourself we will be able to organise successful events.

2

naveen_reloaded • 14y ago

Its true that sometimes the topic can be boring as it involves discussion in law , etc. But do let [r/india](#) know if you are planning for any events , concerned city redditors might give a lending hand and help in organizing .

1



golisoda OP • 14y ago

1. We are not as good as we should be. We do host interns from all over the world at CIS. We are most happy with the interns that come from the University of Toronto in Canada. They come for a whole year and that period of commitment can be invaluable for small organisations such as ourselves. We also have a hackerspace at CIS and student are welcome to visit it and work on projects.
2. We do whenever we get an opportunity and the response has always been very encouraging. Nishant Shah till very recently taught courses ever year in about 5 educational institutions in India.

Thanks for your kind words and please accept my good wishes for 2013!

1



etrast75 • 14y ago

With our own experience, we decided to protect the free speech rights on the internet. It is very clear



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policies in the court of law and/or help people who are threatened by govt agencies for speaking their mind?

2

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Most of our current donors give us funding only for 1 or 2 years at a time. Some court cases both aimed at striking down bad law or defending citizens against unfair implementation of law can be really drawn out and expensive and therefore without a strong base of financial support from ordinary netizens we will never be able to afford this option. Till then we will stick to producing more research and awareness raising.

3

naveen_reloaded • 14y ago

Please let us know if CIS is planning a fund raiser , I will help spread the word and contribute as much as possible..

1

outscribe • 14y ago

If patrons and other groups support you, do you have any plans to go the EFF way? Not just a wish but I would like to know if you actually have any intention. If yes, then we can start garnering support.

With the current trends and direction the Indian central government is going we strongly need a body like this.

2

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Thanks for your support. We do have medium- and long-term plans to go the EFF way. Though courts should always be the last resort when all other means to solve the problem have failed.

2

**utcursch** • 14y ago

What specifically does CIS plan to do with the [11 million grant](#) by the Wikimedia Foundation? I know the generic idea (Indic languages, free knowledge etc.), but are there any specific activities / campaigns you folks are looking at?

1

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

The plan is mostly a modification of the existing India team's plan. Unfortunately, the Programme Director and Programme Manager has decided to leave and we are in the process of replacing them. There made small modifications in the approach.

1. Transparency about the workplan and budget etc. Ideally building on existing transparency standards at CIS.
2. Clearly in service of the community. We would like to support the existing community members and communities instead of duplicating their efforts.
3. Focusing on content donations from government using petitioning and also via Right To Information requests. We are awaiting a legal opinion on licensing compatibility between RTI responses and the Wikinedia http://meta.wikimedia.org/wiki/Global_Development/



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**wontget_fooledagain** • 14y ago

What progress do see taking place in internet governance? Does India have the requisite infrastructure and, more importantly, do Indian policy-makers and bureaucrats have the will to take internet governance seriously?

data.gov.in seems to be a good start(though I don't know how reliable/extensive the data there is), and I don't know if this qualifies as internet governance. I remember hearing about this initiative by the Bangalore municipality where you click a GPS enable photo of a pothole and they come and fix it. What are some important initiatives you've seen taking place in this sphere?

1

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

The term internet governance does not have a single universally accepted definition. India is making progress in some areas for example - access to knowledge but in other areas like speech regulation and privacy there seems to be very little progress from the perspective of ordinary citizens. I cannot answer the question regarding the will of policy-makers and bureaucrats - I think that depends on public pressure.

Data.gov.in is a great first step towards open data and greater transparency. It could be an important element of the enabling environment for better Internet governance. We need more data sets released ASAP by different ministries and departments as per the National Data Sharing and Accessibility Policy (NSDAP). Our report on OGD in India covers some important initiatives <http://cis-india.org/openness/publications/ogd-report>

3

**maribha** • 14y ago

Are you aware of any initiatives that are being taken by the Survey of India to provide updated, accurate and freely accessible map data given that it is a public good? Reference: <http://www.mayin.org/ajayshah/MEDIA/2009/mapsdata.html>

At the moment good data is only available with players like Google, Nokia and MapMyIndia. However, this data is private. The data that is provided on Survey of India's website is outdated.

1

**golisoda** OP • 14y ago

Unfortunately not, we will file some RTIs with the Survey of India to learn more. Thanks for this idea.

1

**Joint_acct** • 14y ago

Does your institution have a website? Does it publish any research that is in the public domain? Also, what kind of policy work goes on at your institution? How are these policies being promoted? Are they lobbied for thru government channels?

2

jackerhack • 14y ago

CIS has a comprehensive website that lists all their work: <http://www.cis-india.org/>



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 **bnattalms** • 14y ago

- ⊖ How are you different in terms of philosophy and focus from IT for Change, the other NGO from Bangalore working on similar issues? Do you have any plans to scale up your organisation? 9 seems to be a very small number to be working on issues of such import. You'll get so caught up in advocacy and public engagements that I fear the quality of your research will suffer. Outsourcing might seem the obvious solution considering you are in the outsourcing capital of the world but surely you are in a position to take on more people.

1

**noxx123456** • 14y ago

serious question : Is there a scope for bribes / corruption in your department ?

In my opinion the hardware procurement anywhere is done by fraudulent tender process ,but the actual employees have no say on that . I have little idea on any other way you can be corrupt in such a department. please care to explain few instances



1

**bikinisland** • 14y ago

Who funds CISI and what are its objectives?

1

 **highlighte** • 14y ago

2

**lordatlas** • 14y ago

- ⊕ Do you prefer beef or pork?

-7

**golisoda OP** • 14y ago

Isn't it funny that even though it has been 1000s of years since the invention of food - we still don't agree as a planet on food regulation. But only decades after the invention of the Internet we are trying to globally harmonise speech regulation.

8

 **[deleted]** • 14y ago

am I missing something here, or is it something only elder people get?

6

 **highlighte** • 14y ago

2

novelty-ahoY • 14y ago**[deleted]** • 14y ago



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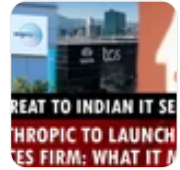
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205 upvotes · 152 comments



r/KeralaSpeaks • 4mo ago

Social media and paid propaganda almost made me forget how stunning India is.

359 upvotes · 63 comments



r/AllIndiaStudentUnion • 1mo ago

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404 upvotes · 88 comments



r/developersIndia • 11d ago

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138 upvotes · 56 comments



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59 upvotes · 50 comments



r/developersIndia • 3mo ago

Developers outside India: What's the sentiment around work moving to Centres in India?

126 upvotes · 37 comments



r/IndianCivicFails • 3mo ago

How would a public service program like this work in India? [Not OC]

25 upvotes · 10 comments



r/IndianTeenagers • 18d ago

The World started to acknowledge India's infrastructure before our own people

8 upvotes · 23 comments



r/IndiaCareers • 1mo ago

27M, Central Govt Job

5 upvotes · 15 comments



r/RemoteJobs • 2mo ago

Hiring: Remote Social Media Specialist in India

24 upvotes · 52 comments

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